



On their voyage, they stopped in the kingdom of Thrace. This was the home of the prophet Phineus. He had once been a great ruler, but he had angered Zeus when he shared too much of the future with his people. As a punishment, Zeus took away his sight and sent terrible monsters called harpies to torment him.

*Each harpy had the head of a woman
but the body of a bird.*

The harpies circled Phineus constantly, and whenever he tried to eat they swooped down and stole the food right out of his hands.

When Jason and his men came across the blind prophet, they took pity on him. Two of the crew waited for Phineus to start his meal and when the harpies flew down to steal it, they ran at them, swords drawn. The monsters were scared off for good. To show his gratitude, Phineus shared with the crew the fastest route to Colchis.

*Whenever Phineus tried to eat, the
harpies stole the food from his hands.*

